

Monitor Your Network Effectively with Monit

Monit is a utility for monitoring and managing programs, processes, files, directories and filesystems on UNIX and Linux systems. Monit monitors systems, maintains them automatically and even repairs them. This article deals with its installation and configuration.



Do you want to know more about what to do if your server goes down? Well, if you have only a little or no idea about network monitoring but are willing to delve into it, Monit gives you a start with the minimum effort.

At the very elementary level, an SNMP (Simple Network Management Protocol) relies on just two basic things—a management server and a managed device. The management server retrieves information from the managed devices and stores it in the information table. However, this data is useless until it's presented properly for the end user. For this, you need a network monitoring tool. And if you are a beginner, you can get nothing better than *Monit* to start with.

According to Wikipedia, Monit “...is a free, open source process supervision tool for UNIX and Linux.” It is written in C by Tildeslash Ltd with its latest stable release being 5.5, and is licensed under the GNU General Public License 3.0. It gained popularity after its use with Ruby on Rails and the Mongrel Web server, since it suits the diverse needs of both.

Features

Monit is an open source utility that is designed for the management and monitoring of the various processes and programs running at a time—the files, directories and more—on a Linux or UNIX system. Although it has a distinctly large number of features, what actually makes it different is its ability to conduct automatic maintenance, i.e., it can execute causal actions, automatically, at the time the error occurs. The following are some features of Monit:

- It monitors the daemon processes or similar ones at the localhost. The daemon processes include programs such as Apache, MySQL, Sendmail and the like.
- It monitors files and directories on the localhost, and is useful in keeping a check on the MD5 or SHA1 checksum of files. It gives alerts if a change is detected.
- It monitors network connections to servers, whether it is on the localhost or on a remote server.
- It monitors general system resources on the localhost such as CPU usage, memory and much more.